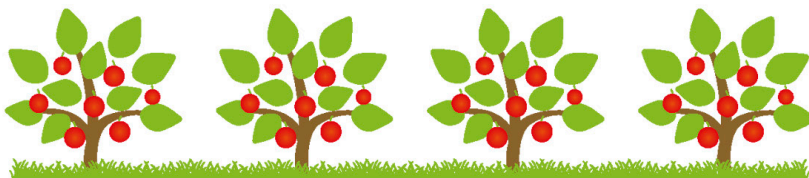


Introduction

The times tables are special shortcuts that make difficult maths fast and easy. They do this by telling you the answers to multiplication and division problems.

Multiplication

Multiplication is a fast way of adding up.



How many apples are there on these trees?
There are two ways you could find out.

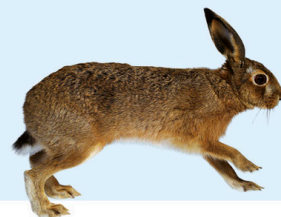
When you see these words, get ready for multiplication:

times lots of
groups of
multiply double



The slow way: You could add together all the apples like this: $7 + 7 + 7 + 7 = 28$.

The speedy way: Or you could multiply them together, like this: $7 \times 4 = 28$.



Division

Division is a fast way of subtracting until you approach or reach zero.



If you pick **15** apples, how many can go in each of these apple pies?
You need to find out how many lots of five are the same as **15**.

When you see these words, get ready for division:

share between
divide
equal groups into



The slow way: You could find out by subtracting, like this: $15 - 5 - 5 - 5 = 0$. That shows that **3** lots of **5** are the same as **15**, so **3** apples can go in each pie.

The speedy way: Or you could divide them together, like this: $15 \div 5 = 3$.

